Zidovudine (ZDV)

FORM 100mg in 10ml oral solution

INDICATION Prophylaxis of HIV infection in newborn infants
This should be commenced within 4 hours of birth

DOSE RANGE

Gestational AGE	DOSE	FREQUENCY	ROUTE
< 30 weeks	2mg/kg	Every 12 hours	Oral
30-33^{+6} weeks	2mg/kg	Every 12 hours for 2 weeks (if 4 week course required then increase to every 8 hours after 2 weeks)	Oral
≥ 34 weeks	4mg/kg*	Every 12 hours	Oral

*round up calculated dose to next 0.5mg for ease of administration

Duration of oral dosing:

- Low risk monotherapy – 2 weeks
- High risk in combination therapy – 4 weeks

CAUTIONS, CONTRA-INDICATIONS AND SIDE EFFECTS
- See Summary of Product Characteristics and most recent edition of BNF for Children (links below)

FURTHER INFORMATION If the baby is vomiting there should be early recourse to intravenous therapy

LICENSED STATUS Licensed for use in all ages

APPLICABLE POLICIES Scottish Perinatal Network guideline: Management of Infants Exposed to HIV in Pregnancy

BHIVA guidelines on the management of HIV in pregnancy and the postpartum period 2025

Consult local policy if applicable

Document Number:	004	Supersedes:	003
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Date Prepared	July 2026	Review Date	July 2029

Dose may vary depending on indication, age, renal function, hepatic function, and concomitant medications.
This monograph should be used in conjunction with the terms of reference document prepared by the West of Scotland Pharmacist Group. Information is correct at the time of publication and as per local practice agreement.
For further advice contact your clinical pharmacist or pharmacy department.